

“THE DEMAND FOR CCD BOARD CAMERAS IS GROWING AT 40 PER CENT ANNUALLY”



In today's uncertain times, the need for security solutions is far greater. Sparsh offers integrated security solutions to help secure corporate, government and residential buildings, airports, bus stations, hospitals, malls, educational institutions and other public places 24 hours a day, seven days a week. Incorporated in 1999, Sparsh designs, manufactures, markets, sells and services a full range of high-technology security products. Atanu Kumar Das of EFY met up with Sanjeev Sehgal, managing director of Sparsh, to find out more about the company's recently launched CCD board cameras

■ SANJEEV SEHGAL
MANAGING DIRECTOR, SPARSH

Sparsh claims to have launched India's first indigenously manufactured CCD board cameras. Can you shed some light on these cameras?

CCD board cameras are an integral part of CCTV cameras. We have been manufacturing CCTV switchers, video amplifiers, power supplies and other CCTV accessories for the last eight years. We have added technologically advanced products at regular intervals during this time. In addition, we have expanded our operations by setting up a manufacturing facility in Haridwar. It has provided us with flexibility to expand into new product lines.

CCD board cameras are a natural extension to our CCTV product line. Sony Electronics (Singapore) was looking for a partner to manufacture these cameras in India. So we joined hands with them and developed these CCD board cameras.

Is your plant ready to meet the market demand?

According to various industry reports, the estimated demand for CCD board cameras is approximately 50,000 units per month, growing at 40 per cent annually. We plan to manufacture 20,000 units per month by the end of this financial year.

What is your target audience for these cameras?

Our target customers are the bulk buyers, who buy these board cameras and assemble them into cameras, OEMs to whom we can supply complete cameras, and end customers—we'll market complete cameras through our distributors all over India, who, in turn, will install these for the end customers.

How has been the response to the launch? Do you also

plan to export these cameras?

We have received a tremendous response from all quarters of the security industry. Everyone is appreciating our effort and feels that we have set a benchmark for the electronic security industry. At present, as the demand for these cameras is very high in India, we don't think that we will be able to export them this year but we definitely plan to export them in the next financial year.

How has Sony helped you in this venture?

Sony Electronics (Singapore) has been quite supportive in developing these cameras. They are the key component suppliers. They helped us in integrating their CCD and other key components by providing us circuit designs, software and manufacturing tips. The most important part is the pricing of Sony components. They have provided us with their components at such competitive prices that we can compete with any other supplier of CCD board cameras in India.

Lastly, your views on the need for security solutions?

Security is the integral part of any society. It was, is and will be available in different forms. With technological advancements, the complexities are increasing and hence the level of electronic security equipment required to handle them is also increasing.

We need to remain vigilant against threats from terrorists, naxalites and other anti-social elements. To control and minimise these events, we need more and more intelligent systems. With the help of these equipments, we can take control and, with the database available after such incidents, reach to the culprits and plan for such undesirable situations more efficiently.